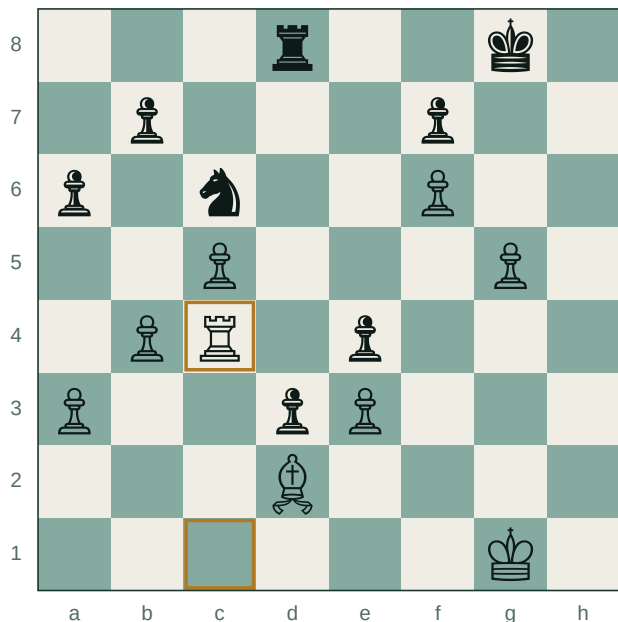


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 33

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Rc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...Ne5 34. Rxe4 Nf3+ 35. Kf2 Nxd2

33...Ne5 The knight moves from c6 to e5. Recorded reply: **34.Rxe4**.

34...Nf3+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on d2. Recorded reply: **35.Kf2**.

35...Nxd2 The knight captures the bishop on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c4 and bishop on d2. Check for tactical protection.